

SOLID STATE

Route Bible - Version 1.0

Frozen route, pacing, priority, material-continuity, and age-distribution design for the first playable.

1. Purpose

This document defines how Solid State produces coherent life trajectories without mid-life player choices. It fixes the rules for age pacing, event drafting, route priority, material commitment, route continuation, hidden routes, and the intended age distribution of Permanent Form endings.

2. Player Agency

After setup, life proceeds automatically. The player selects three talents, allocates starting attributes, then watches the simulation. During life she may change playback speed or inspect information, but she does not choose jobs, treatments, contracts, legal responses, transformation types, route branches, or endings. A route is an internal emergent trajectory; a branch is an automatically selected conditional outcome.

3. Time Step: Exactly One Visible Event Per Year

Every age produces exactly one visible life event. Event text should normally be one or two short sentences. Even emergencies, legal disputes, transformation sequences, and hidden routes obey this rule. A route may reserve future years, but it should not normally emit several visible same-age events.

4. Internal Event Resolution

One annual event may still perform several internal operations: choose an automatic branch variant, modify attributes, add or remove flags, set or change material commitment, schedule future events, or terminate the run. These operations do not create extra visible timeline entries.

5. Annual Resolution Order

For each age:

1. advance age;
2. resolve the highest-priority valid route/scheduled event, if any;
3. otherwise build the age/state channel profile;
4. draft a channel;
5. draft an eligible family;
6. draft one event;
7. resolve its automatic branch;
8. apply effects and flags;
9. schedule future consequences;
10. evaluate dormant threshold talents until stable;
11. save;
12. advance to the next age.

6. Priority Order

Only one annual event is displayed. Priority order is:

1. ending / committed hidden-route climax;
2. mandatory committed-route continuation;
3. scheduled priority event;
4. normal age/state drafting.

Within the same priority class, use an authored priority rank. Equal-ranked valid events use seeded random resolution. Displaced scheduled events may remain pending only inside their authored validity window.

7. No Event Backlog

Scheduled events require an earliest age, latest age, priority, and validity condition. If displaced by higher-priority events they may move within that window. If the window expires or the route state becomes invalid, they are discarded. The simulator should not accumulate long queues of stale route events.

8. Route Shapes

Most routes are soft: they add flags and influence future eligibility while ordinary life continues between route events. A committed route may temporarily reserve consecutive years, normally 2-5 years for an ordinary climax. Longer hard sequences are reserved for exceptional hidden content. Route meaning emerges through accumulation across years, not same-year event chains.

9. Route Entry and Abandonment

Routes should often begin with ordinary-looking events such as employment, school, family, insurance, medical screening, or museum contact. Route flags can later be removed, causing the route to disappear naturally without a special 'route failed' message. Some routes may be re-entered; unique hidden initiations and irreversible transformation stages are normally one-time.

10. Event Drafting Hierarchy

Normal annual drafting is hierarchical rather than flat:

Age/state profile -> Channel -> Family -> Event.

This allows species and talents to have perceptible effects without making every event compete in one enormous pool.

11. Event Channels

Core channels are:

- Ordinary: education, career, friendship, romance, family, housing, hobbies, ordinary finance and health.
- Institutional / World: government, insurance, corporate, museum, legal, finance, hospital, religion, university, news/media.
- Transformation: stone, metal, crystal, wood, glass, ceramic, synthetic, temporal, mixed/anomalous.
- Route / Special: rare talent chains, hidden reincarnation content, anomalous events, major secret trajectories.

12. Age 0-17: Development Phase

The simulator starts at age 0. Childhood and adolescence exist to build character history, move visible attributes, establish species-specific experiences, and support education satire.

Before age 18, ordinary random events may produce:

- minor or temporary solidification symptoms;
- Fixation changes;
- screening results;
- non-binding material hints;
- social or institutional reactions.

They should not normally produce:

- irreversible Material Commitment;
- severe transformation injury;
- canonical Permanent Form endings.

This is a pacing/content rule rather than a claim that minors are biologically immune.

13. Education as Worldbuilding

School should be a major source of black humor. Examples include species-biased career counseling, transformation-risk screenings, school insurance, wing-compatible furniture that fits nobody, post-mobility tax questions on exams, and standardized testing that predicts future Permanent Form suitability. Childhood should still contain warm

and ordinary events so the dystopian elements have contrast.

14. Money Before Adulthood

MNY represents household economic circumstances and access to resources during childhood. In adulthood it gradually represents the protagonist's own financial position. The same stat remains valid across life phases; no separate family-wealth stat is needed.

15. Age-Based Channel Profile

The following is the frozen v1 pacing target for neutral channel weights before Fixation, talents, route state, and other modifiers:

Age	Ordinary	Institutional	Transformation	Route / Special
0-5	82	15	3	0
6-11	72	22	6	0
12-17	62	25	11	2
18-24	49	23	22	6
25-34	37	22	31	10
35-44	38	21	29	12
45-54	41	20	27	12
55-64	39	19	30	12
65+	35	18	34	13

16. Two-Wave Transformation Curve

The game should not use a simple monotonic 'older = more transformation' curve. Serious transformation pressure rises sharply in young adulthood, peaks around ages 25-34, softens somewhat for survivors in later middle age, then rises again in late life.

This creates:

- early-adult institutional vulnerability;
- a primary 25-34 conversion window;
- mid-life preservation / crisis satire after 35;
- unusual long-mobility survivor content;
- a late-life second wave.

17. Permanent Form Age Distribution Target

For ordinary completed runs, the intended first-pass distribution of final Permanent Form ages is approximately:

- 0-17: ~0%;
- 18-24: 18-22%;
- 25-34: 35-40%;
- 35-44: 20-25%;
- 45-54: 8-12%;
- 55-64: 4-7%;
- 65+: 2-5%.

These are simulation balance targets, not hard-coded ending probabilities.

18. Mid-Life Crisis as Preservation Culture

After 35, transformation pressure changes meaning. Instead of only accidents and institutional vulnerability, the world increasingly markets deliberate preservation, legacy, age stabilization, executive conversion, prestige materials, and 'final version of yourself' services. This supports black humor around society turning mid-life anxiety into a permanence industry.

19. Fixation and Channel Pressure

Fixation modifies channel pressure, especially the Transformation channel. The exact numeric mapping belongs in machine-facing balance constants. The qualitative bands remain:

0-20 Reduced; 21-40 Normal; 41-60 Elevated; 61-80 Strong; 81+ Very Strong.

High Fixation does not automatically create an ending. It makes relevant authored events eligible and more likely.

20. Species and Family Drafting

Species tendencies primarily affect the family-selection stage after a channel has been chosen. Exact multipliers are intentionally not part of the creative Bible. Primary species tendencies must be strong enough to be perceptible in play, while still allowing stereotype-breaking outcomes.

21. Material Is Not a Route

Social routes describe why and under what institutional circumstances transformation occurs. Material describes the physical trajectory. Corporate, Legal, Museum, Family, Finance, Religious, Medical, and other routes may coexist without each owning a separate material.

22. Material Commitment

Before commitment, transformation families may compete according to species, talents, history, and route state. A sufficiently important authored event may set a discrete Material Commitment such as wood, crystal, metal, stone, glass, ceramic, synthetic, temporal, or mixed.

Material Commitment is not a meter.

23. Material Progression Stages

Material-related events may be:

- Suggestive: a hint; no commitment.
- Manifesting: visible/temporary changes; still reversible.
- Committing: an authored event establishes materialCommitment.
- Final: Permanent Form ending.

A childhood screening or minor symptom should not silently lock the future material.

24. After Material Commitment

Once a material is committed, normal Transformation drafting should remain within that material family. Other active social routes adapt to the committed material rather than introducing competing material trajectories. Unrelated materials become ineligible unless an event is explicitly authored as a transition or mixed-material event.

25. Mixed Materials

Mixed-material forms are allowed only as intentional authored outcomes. Examples include marble with gold repairs, wood sealed in resin, porcelain reinforced with metal, or crystal incorporated into bronze architecture. Most lives should still finish with one primary material. Finishes and coatings are metadata, not competing material families.

26. Material vs Form

Material answers 'what is she made of?'. Form answers 'what kind of object/body does she become?'. Mannequin is primarily a form and may be synthetic resin, wood, porcelain, or another material. Potential forms include statue, mannequin, monument, architectural component, figurine, relief, preserved humanoid body, and temporal still-frame.

Version 1 does not need a full independent Form engine, but ending data should leave room for form metadata.

27. Temporal Fixation

Temporal Fixation is treated mechanically as a transformation family even though no literal solid material may exist. In-world, whether it legally counts as solidification remains controversial. It can intersect with legal, medical, religious, financial, academic, and hidden routes.

28. Route Competition at Ending

Once material is committed, climax competition should primarily be about social meaning and legal outcome rather than competing materials. For example, a Crystal commitment combined with Museum, Corporate, and Legal routes might produce Crystal Archivist, Corporate Display, or Self-Owned Permanent Citizen depending on priority and conditions.

29. Major Route Families

Version 1 establishes:

- Corporate Preservation
- Museum and Art
- Medical Continuity
- Legal Personhood
- Finance / Debt / Bankruptcy
- Civic and Political Memorial
- Religious and Ceremonial
- Architectural and Industrial
- Family and Inheritance
- Academic and Research
- Temporal Fixation

Material families cut across these social routes.

30. First-Slice Route Coverage

For the first ~100-event playable, fully represent Corporate, Museum, Medical, Legal, Finance, Architectural, Family, and Temporal routes. Seed Civic, Religious, and Academic routes more lightly. A fully represented route should have at least two entry events, multiple continuations, at least one automatic branch, at least one intersection with another route, and at least one reachable Permanent Form ending.

31. Hidden Routes

Hidden routes remain fully automatic and use the existing event, flag, talent, achievement, AEVT, scheduling, and priority systems. Before commitment, hidden events appear as rare opportunities. After commitment, mandatory future events may override ordinary drafting. Hidden routes must not require a new UI, real-time gameplay, maps, simultaneous former selves, or extra hidden numeric meters.

32. Attribute Drift

Events are the primary source of CHR, INT, STR, MNY, SPR, and FIX changes after setup. The first-slice content target remains that at least 45% of authored random events modify one or more visible attributes and at least 15% modify two or more. This is necessary for threshold talents to trigger naturally during life.

33. Threshold Talents

Dormant one-shot threshold talents are evaluated after the year's event is fully resolved. If a talent triggers, its effect is permanent and is never revoked. Triggered effects may satisfy other dormant talents; evaluate repeatedly until stable. A talent triggered by the current event cannot retroactively change that event's branch.

34. Event Text and Fast Forward

Annual events should normally be one or two short sentences so the timeline remains readable at 1x and 2x playback. Fast-forward changes presentation timing only; it never changes RNG or outcome.

35. Future Cadence Fallback

Version 1 remains strictly one visible event per year. Do not implement half-year ticks now.

If playtesting shows that the typical 25-34 ending window produces lives that feel too short or insufficiently developed, a future version may change the simulation cadence to two events per chronological year (0.5-year ticks). This must be treated as a global pacing migration, not as ad hoc extra events, and must preserve deterministic seeded behavior.

Until evidence from playtesting requires it, one event per year is authoritative.

36. Core Principle

The route system should make the player think: 'Of course her life ended up here,' even though she never chose the route. Coherence comes from decades of short annual events, accumulating attributes, institutions, material commitment, and route history.